

# PGD WITHDRAWN

ADHD Monitoring and Ongoing Supply · Methylphenidate (Concerta XL / Equasym XL)

**This Patient Group Direction has been withdrawn and must not be used.**

## Reason

Methylphenidate is a Schedule 2 controlled drug. A Patient Group Direction is not a lawful mechanism for supplying it, by any staff group.

NHS Specialist Pharmacy Service guidance, updated 1 July 2026, states that unless a controlled drug is on its permitted list it cannot be supplied or administered under a PGD. For Schedule 2 the list is morphine and diamorphine, restricted to registered nurses and pharmacists for the immediate necessary treatment of a sick or injured person, and ketamine. Methylphenidate is not on it.

## **This replaces the correction notice issued earlier on 7 September 2026**

That notice removed pharmacy technicians as authorised users and stated that every other provision of the document remained in force. That was incorrect. The problem is not who operates this PGD; it is that a PGD cannot carry this medicine at all.

## What to do now

Do not supply methylphenidate under this or any PGD. Patients require a prescription or a Patient Specific Direction from an appropriate prescriber. Anyone currently being supplied should be referred to their specialist or GP without interruption to treatment.

**Stopping a stimulant abruptly is not desirable; arrange continuity, do not simply stop.**

Withdrawn 7 September 2026 · Get Real Health